

Quick recap

The meeting focused on reviewing and refining messaging strategy for the organization's 30th anniversary campaign. The team discussed updates to a presentation deck that included insights, competitive analysis, and a proposed messaging framework with key supporting pillars. They debated how to balance national branding with regional nuances, ultimately deciding to create a unified brand framework that would be customized by region rather than using completely different headlines for each location. The group also addressed logo variations for different regions and discussed the need for content mapping to show how messaging would be applied across various media pieces and funnel stages. Additionally, they reviewed ongoing project updates including 30th anniversary webpage development, email signatures, and recruitment banner designs.

Summary

Messaging Review Meeting Discussion

The meeting began with casual conversation about weekend activities and driving with a one-year-old. Rachel Kotler mentioned having multiple stops and attending a birthday party, resulting in six hours of driving. The group then transitioned to discussing messaging, with Emory preparing to present on a time-sensitive topic that had received comments. The conversation ended with Emory starting to share their screen to review the messaging materials.

Presentation Deck Updates and Analysis

Suzette Weir and Courtney updated the presentation deck based on feedback received, including insights, research findings, and a competitive analysis framework. They discussed the need for a comprehensive competitive analysis, with Emory suggesting the use of previously identified top competitors while acknowledging the importance of market share data to determine the scope. The team also discussed incorporating inspiring student stories, such as Shatavia Knight's, into future messaging to highlight the impact of educational opportunities.

Social Media Messaging Strategy Framework

Anthony Emezu and Suzette Weir discussed the need to highlight key priorities and social media metrics in their presentation, including followers, views, and engagement metrics. They reviewed a framework for messaging that includes "zip code destiny" as an ownable concept, with different lenses for audience appeal to parents, teachers, donors, and board members. The team agreed to align on the key message to guide creative exploration, with Suzette Weir noting the importance of showing how the message supports their strategic "why."

Advertising Messaging Strategy Discussion

The team discussed messaging strategy for advertising copy, focusing on core messages like "find your voice, discover your passion" and potential variations such as "potential meets purpose" and "belief without boundaries." Anthony Emezu asked about incorporating

data-backed results into the messaging, which Emory clarified would be used to support and explain the chosen language rather than as part of the ad copy itself. The discussion centered on balancing a unified brand approach across regions while allowing for regional nuance in supporting messages, with Rachel Kotler suggesting that having different supporting pillars by region could address the feedback about needing regional nuance while maintaining an overarching key message.

Unified Campaign Framework Development

The team discussed developing a unified campaign concept with regional variations, emphasizing the need to get buy-in from stakeholders while showing appreciation for previous feedback. They aligned on creating a brand framework with consistent positioning and supporting pillars that can be customized for different regions, with 80% consistency and 20% regional adjustments. The team agreed to refine the language of key supporting pillars and map out the required level of detail for different collateral pieces, with Emory suggesting they could use this framework to avoid detailed line-by-line approval processes from partners.

Content Mapping and Messaging Strategy

The team discussed content mapping and messaging strategy for different marketing materials. Rachel Kotler explained her plan to create content maps with three levels of detail: headline-focused, hybrid, and detailed formats. Suezette Weir emphasized the need for clear content mapping on the paid side to avoid confusion and provide a framework for regional implementation. The group agreed to create a duplicate funnel slide identifying which media and collateral pieces sit in each funnel stage as a first step, though they acknowledged this might need more detailed nuance in the future.

30th Anniversary Branding Strategy

The team discussed branding strategy for the 30th anniversary campaign, deciding to create logo lockups with "30 years" for North Star NYC, Roxbury Prep, and USI, while Camden and Rochester would use the copy "backed by 20 years of proven results" without logos. Anthony Emezu suggested incorporating the tagline "three decades of academic excellence" where space permits, and the team agreed to develop a brand architecture framework document to guide regional teams. The group determined they need to identify who needs to review the brand framework, with Suezette Weir suggesting regions should focus on headlines and collateral rather than detailed feedback on ad copy, and Rachel Kotler recommending setting clear expectations about the type of feedback desired.

Project Priorities and Copy Development

The team discussed project priorities and next steps for copy development and design work. Anthony Emezu will focus on headlines first, followed by regional RTBs and copy variations, while Suezette Weir will update upfront slides based on Marianne's feedback. The team agreed to meet Thursday to review deck updates and copy constructs, with Anthony Emezu planning to connect with Courtney tomorrow to discuss copy details. They also confirmed that 30th anniversary logo variations can be worked on in parallel with ad copy development, and Rachel

Kotler will schedule a brief meeting on Monday to review existing projects including pre-K materials and 30th anniversary bookmarks.

Project Updates and Progress Review

The team discussed updates on various projects including the 30th anniversary webpage, email signatures, and content for summer PD covers. Anthony Emezu reported that the summer content PD covers were completed and ready to be sent once internet connectivity issues were resolved. Suezette Weir provided updates on enrollment progress monitoring meetings, Market Cloud presentation materials, and a lead integration issue that was resolved with a workaround implemented by data and IT on Friday affecting 716 leads across three regions. The team also discussed an upcoming SOW that needed to be signed by Emory due to the dollar amount and multi-year relationship.